

and unnatural sex help a little. Travel, booze, massage, meditation, Club Med, and rediscovering God give us a respite. But stress takes its toll. Ulcers, back pain, high blood pressure, and "substance abuse" plague compulsive achievers in their 30s and 40s.

Life in the fast lane can ruin more than your health. Marriages these days last an average of eight or nine years. Half of America's children live with one parent or the other, but not both. How many families collapse because parents absorb tension on the job and take it out on those waiting at home?

I started working at Peat Marwick in San Francisco in 1972. When people with money in San Francisco hang it up, they can drive two hours down the California coast to Carmel. Carmel has a cool climate and ocean breezes. It has more golf courses than Harvard has M.B.A.s. A house on the water near Carmel can strain even the fattest budget. Houses seem to be built for two people but on the assumption that they want to lose each other. An architect once told me the problem is how to design a nine-thousand-square-foot house that has a decent place to read.

In short, Carmel is the perfect place for the reasonably rich to retire.

For years I watched partners from San Francisco's most elite firms put away their briefcases, get a new set of golf clubs, and move to Carmel. They were going to play eighteen holes with their wives in the morning and eighteen with the guys later on. They were going to relax and enjoy the money they had worked so hard to save.

And some of them did—for six months or so. Then they had heart attacks and died.

The numbers back up the anecdotal evidence. Life expectancy for American men ranks only twenty-fourth in the world, partly because we have so many fatal heart attacks so early in life. Life expectancy for women ranks much higher, ninth in the world. But American women seem determined to